

Instructor: Date:

Learner: Regional Branch:

Program: Center:

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Let's Start!

Writing Spot: Peter is stressed out. Too much work and too little time!



Learning Outcome

Identify and describe plans for the organization of events.

Ask your partner:

- Do you often feel stress? When do you get stressed?
- What do you do to relax?

Can Do Statements

- I can talk about subjects to study.
- I can use an essay outline.
- I can report about actions, events or people.





Let's Explore!

Peter is worried. His English essay is due **shortly***. Listen to his conversation with Vanessa.

* "Shortly" means in a brief period of time.



Instructions: Read the text aloud.

- Vanessa:** What's the matter? You look upset.
Peter: I've got to write a final English paper for class. It's a 2000 word essay and I'm running out of time.
Vanessa: You look stressed out.
Peter: Between work and school, I'm being stretched too thin.
Vanessa: You need to look after yourself. I felt the same way at cooking school sometimes.
Peter: Yeah, and you weren't working at the same time. English essays require so much work!
Vanessa: Want some advice?
Peter: Sure.
Vanessa: Take a walk in the park and clear your head.
Peter: Alright.
Vanessa: Then, go home and have a hot shower. It will help you relax.
Peter: Ok, do you know how to write a great essay?
Vanessa: I have a lot of resources on my computer. When I get home, I'll e-mail you the information.
Peter: That sounds great! I really appreciate it.



Let's Practice!

Essay writing requires planning and structure.

Instructions: Choose all the correct answers.

1. What should you include in an essay?
- ☐ Introduction
 - ☐ Informal language
 - ☐ Conclusion
 - ☐ Thesis
 - ☐ Topic sentences
 - ☐ Contractions



Let's Practice!

How does Sally plan to help Peter with his assignment?

Instructions: Draw a line from the first part of the statement on the left to the second part on the right.

COLUMN A

1. I've got to write a final English
2. It's a 2000-word essay
3. I have a lot of resources
4. English essays require
5. Between work and school,
6. Take a walk in the park

COLUMN B

- a. and clear your head.
- b. paper for class.
- c. on my computer.
- d. I'm being stretched too thin.
- e. so much work!
- f. and I'm running out of time.





Extension Activity

Let's learn more about the structure of essays. It's time to do some research!

Instructions: Complete the following steps. Fill in the Self-Assessment.

- Go on the Internet.
- Find a simple English essay on a topic of your choice.
- Read the essay.
- Complete the essay outline below.

Self-Assessment

Yes No

I research ways to communicate through writing.

☐ ☐

I complete a table to show understanding.

☐ ☐

I explain the main points of the essay to a partner.

☐ ☐

Topic:

Thesis statement:

What is the first paragraph about?

What is the second paragraph about?

What is the third paragraph about?

What does the conclusion include?

Which examples does it give to support the main points?



Target Words

- stretched too thin** (expression): to be unable to complete tasks properly because of time
e.g. I'm being stretched too thin.
- running out of** (expression): to not have enough to complete
e.g. I am running out of time to write my English essay.
- advice** (noun): suggestion
e.g. Would you like some advice?
- clear your head** (expression): to relax your mind
e.g. You need to go to the park and clear your head.
- thesis** (noun): the sentence in an essay that tells the reader the specific purpose or argument of your paper
e.g. You have to include a thesis in your essay.





Learning Points

Elements of an Essay

Introduction: An introduction starts with general statements and then moves to a specific topic, and ends with a thesis.

Thesis: In your introduction your thesis statement specifically communicates the main point or argument of your essay. Each body paragraph must support your thesis.

Body Paragraphs: You use a minimum of three body paragraphs in an essay. Each body paragraph contains information that supports your thesis.

Topic Sentences: You begin each body paragraph with a topic sentence. This sentence supports the thesis. All the information in the paragraph is clearly related to the topic sentence.

Support: In each body paragraph, you need to use arguments, analysis, examples, details or facts that clearly support your topic sentence. You need to include three or more points to support each topic sentence.

Conclusion: The conclusion ends your essay. It often restates the thesis and summarizes the main points of your essay. You should never add new information or arguments in your conclusion. It should draw your essay to a close.

Using the Past Tense and Past Continuous Tense

You use the **past tense** when talking about actions that have already happened.

Examples:

- Yesterday, I ate potatoes for dinner.
- I bought these pants last week.

You use the **past continuous tense** when talking about actions in the past that happened for a period of time.

Examples:

- She was always talking during class.
- She was never on time for our meetings.

